Andy Gonçalves

Engineering Leader

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Intro

I'm an engineering leader with 12+ years in tech, having held hands-on software engineering and management roles at start-ups and scale-ups. I've led teams through platform rebuilds, product pivots, and organizational scaling in fast-moving environments, always with a focus on continuous improvement, growing people, and data-informed decisions. Looking for leadership roles with technical engagement and a focus on leveraging AI for efficiency.

Professional Experience

2024–2026 **Astrada (Formerly Fidel API)**, *(2y)*, Senior Engineering Manager.

Established teams for product alignment and delivery processes that led to a stable average 3-day cycle time (P85: 1 week) across 2 teams (12 engineers total).

Owned performance management. Ran PIPs (60% success rate) and managed exits where unsuccessful. Grew engineers from mid- to senior-level impact.

Defined on-call, starting with holiday 24/7 coverage and expanding into a year-round rotation.

Pushed for alert sanitization and visibility, bringing incidents' Mean Time to Detect (MTTD) from hours down to minutes.

2022–2024 **Fidel API**, *(2y)*, Engineering Manager.

Built a 3-engineer team from scratch (internal transfers + new hires, front-end and back-end), establishing all delivery processes for a PM new to agile; grew the team to 8 to incorporate senior and mobile hires as scope increased.

Executed a 30% team reduction as part of company-wide layoffs, realigning headcount to budget.

Restructured teams and delivery processes to execute a company-wide product pivot, delivering a rebuilt platform with feature parity, PCI compliance, and new integrations within 3 months.

2020–2022 **Talkdesk**, *(2y)*, Engineering Manager.

Managed teams responsible for the product's core systems - call routing and assignment, peaking at 4 teams (18 people) across 2 domains.

Brought predictability to large deliverables by stabilizing task sizes and introducing Monte Carlo simulations.

Established a delivery process for a 10-person cross-functional team.

2016–2020 **Talkdesk**, *(4y)*, Software Engineer.

Designed and developed the new core systems of the product, responsible for routing calls. Maintained legacy call routing systems. Scrum mastered and helped with planning.

2013–2016 **Safira/KPMG**, *(2.5y)*, Software Developer.
Developed full-stack corporate web applications and middleware for banks and insurance companies.

Technologies

General OO/functional programming, TDD, API design, event-driven architectures, SQL, NoSQL.

Languages **Proficient:** Ruby, Elixir. **Familiar:** Go, Java, Node.js, Javascript.

Education

2011–2013 **Master's in Computer Science Engineering**, *Nova University*, Lisbon, *17/20*.
2-year MSc (Eng), focus on distributed systems. Thesis in cloud computing, grade of *18/20*.

2008–2011 **Diploma in Computer Science Engineering**, *Nova University*, Lisbon, *15/20*.
3-year BSc (Eng).

Last updated: September 3, 2026